# How to request a leave of absence

Use this article when you will be away for more than five consecutive scheduled workdays. For a shorter absence, request paid sick leave or PTO in Workday instead.

## Before you start

- Have your expected start date and estimated return date ready.
- Know whether the leave is for you or for a family member.
- You do not need a doctor's note to open the request.

## Steps

1. In Workday, select Absence, then Request Absence.
2. Choose Leave of Absence as the type.
3. Select the reason category. If you are unsure, choose Medical - Self and the Absence Management team will reclassify it if needed.
4. Enter the expected dates. Estimated dates are fine; you can revise them later.
5. Submit. You will receive a case number within one business day.
6. Watch for a secure message from Absence Management with any forms you need.

## What your manager sees

Your manager sees the dates and the approval status. Your manager does not see the reason category, any forms you submit, or any medical information. If your manager asks for a diagnosis, you are not required to provide it; contact Employee Relations.

## Pay during leave

Pay depends on the leave type and your location. Absence Management confirms your pay arrangement in writing after the case is opened. Do not assume a leave is unpaid based on what a colleague told you; the answer differs by state and by leave type.

## Returning to work

Contact Absence Management at least five (5) business days before your planned return so that systems access and payroll are restored on time. If your return date changes, update the case rather than telling your manager only.


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